Morpheme	Meaning	Notes	Examples
abdomin-	abdomen		abdominiscopy
acanth-	thorn; spine		acanthocyte
acar-	mite		acarodermatitis
acet-	vinegar; acid	combining vowel -o- or -i-	acetic acid
acetabul-	hip socket; acetabulum		acetabulum
achill-	Achilles tendon		
acid-	sour; acid		aciduric
acin-	grape; acinus		
acou-	hear	also acu-	acoustic, dysacusis
acous-	hear		
acr-	extremity (esp. hands / feet); peak		acromegaly
acromi-	acromion (lateral projection of shoulder blade)		acromion
act-	do; drive; act		reaction
actin-	ray; radius; radiation		actinobacillus
acu-	sharp; severe; sudden		
acus-	hear		
adamant(in)-	enamel		
adelph-	brother		
aden-	gland		adenoma
adip(os)-	fat		adipocellular
adren-	adrenal gland		adrenal
æm-	blood		anæmia
æqu-	equal		
aër-	air; gas		anaerobiosis
æsthe-	perceived; sense; sensation; sensitivity; sensory perception		anæsthesia
æti-	cause; origin		ætiology
agog-	lead (verb); draw forth; stimulate flow; induce		
ailur-	cat		
al-	wing		
alb-	white		albiduria
album-	albumin		albumin
albumin-	albumin		albumin
alcohol-	alcohol		alcohol
alg-	pain (in)		algophobia, neuralgia
alges-	sense of pain		analgesia, algesimeter
alkal-	alkali	combining vowel -i- or -o-	
all-	other; divergence; difference from		allergy, allotropism, allorhythmia
allant-	sausage		allantiasis, allantoid
allel-	of one another		allelic
allerg-	allergy		
allotri-	strange		allotriogeustia
alve-	trough; channel; hollow; cavity; socket; sac		alveobronchiolitis
alveol-	alveolus; small cavity; small sac		alveolitis
ambly-	dull; faint; feeble		amblyopia
amel-	enamel		
amni-	bowl; fœtal membrane; amniotic sac; amnion		amniocentesis, amnion
amœb-	change; amoeba		amœboid
amygdal-	almond; tonsil		amygdalin; amygdaloid
amyl-	starch		amyluria
an-	anus; ring		
anaphylact-	intense allergic reaction		
ancon-	elbow		
andr-	man; male		androgen
angi-	(blood) vessel; duct		angioma
angin-	choking pain		
anis-	unequal; uneven		anisocoria
ankyl-	fused; stiffened; hooked; crooked; looped	sometimes ancyl-	ankylosis; ancylostomiasis
anter-	in front; front; before		anterolateral
anth-	flower; blossom		
anthrac-	coal; anthrax; carbon; charcoal		anthrax, anthracosilicosis
anthrop-	human being; person; man		anthropomorphism
antr-	cavern; antrum		antrocele
anul-	ring; circle	diminutive of an-	
aort-	aorta		aorta
aph-	touch		dysaphia
aphrodisi-	sexual desire		
api-	bee	no combining vowel	
apic-	top; summit; apex		apicoectomy
append(ic)-	appendix		appendicitis
aqu-	water		
aque-	watery		
arachn-	spider; web; arachnoid membrane		arachnodactyly
arch-	beginning; origin; original; ancient; primitive; first; chief; principal		archenteron
archæ-	ancient; primitive; original; first; chief; principal		archæopteryx
arct(at)-	compress		
are-	open space		areolar
argent-	silver		
argyr-	silver		
arsen(ic)-	arsenic		
arteri-	artery; windpipe	can be arter- before i—	arteriosclerosis, periarteritis
arthr-	joint		synarthrosis
articul-	joint		disarticulation
asc(it)-	sac; bag; bladder; dropsy		
asperg-	sprinkle		
astr-	star		astrocyte
astragal-	talus		
atel-	incomplete	a• + tel-	atelocardia
ather-	gruel; fatty deposit; yellowish plaque		atherosclerosis
atlant-	atlas		atlantoaxial
atm-	steam; vapour		atmosphere
atres-	not perforated; lack of opening in	a• + tres-	
atret-	not perforated; lack of opening in	a• + tres-	atretostomia
atri-	atrium; chamber; cavity		atrioventricular
audi-	hear		audiometry
aur-	gold		
aur-	ear; hearing		aurinasal
aure-	golden yellow		
aux-	increase; grow; enlargement		auxotrophic
av-	bird	combining vowel -i-	
ax-	axis; axon		axolemma
axi-	axis; axon		uniaxial
axill-	armpit		
axis-	axis		
axon-	axis; axon		axonopathy
azot-	nitrogen; urea		
ba-	go; walk; stand		abasia
bacc-	berry		
bacill-	small staff; rod; bacillus	kind of bacteria	actinobacillosis
bacteri-	small staff; rod; bacteria		bacteriophage
balan-	acorn; glans penis		balanitis
ball-	throw		ballismus
bar-	pressure; weight; heavy; dull; hard		barosinusitis
bary-	pressure; weight; heavy; dull; hard		
bas-	base		basophil
basi-	base		basioglossus
bath-	deep		bathorhodopsin
bathy-	deep		bathypnea
bi-	life		microbe, aerobic
bili-	bile		bilious
blast-	bud; child; early growth; primitive cell; immature cell		blastoma
blenn-	mucus		blennorrhea
blep-	look		monoblepsia
blephar-	eyelid		blepharitis
bol-	throw		embolism
botan-	plant		
bov-	cow; ox; bull		
brachi-	arm		brachiocephalic
brachy-	short		brachydactyly
brady-	slow	no combining vowel	bradycardia
branch-	gill		
breph-	embryo		brephoplastic
brevi-	short		brevicollis
brom-	stench		bromhidrosis
bronch-	windpipe; bronchus		bronchoscopy
bronchi-	windpipe; bronchus		
bry-	swell; grow (with life); moss		embryonic
bucc-	cheek		buccocclusion
bulb-	bulb		bulbospiral
burs-	pouch; sack; bursa (sac of sinovial fluid)		
butyr-	butter		butyrophenon
cac-	bad; abnormal; defective; terrible		cacogeusia
cæc-	blind; cæcum		cæcotomy
calc-	heel		calcaneodynia
calc(in)-	calcium; stone; lime (salts)		calcipexy
calcane-	heel bone; calcaneus		calcaneus
calor-	heat; energy		calorimeter
campt-	bent		camptodactyly
can-	dog		
cancr-	crab; cancer		cancroid
candid-	white		
canth-	corner of the eye		canthoplasty
capill(ar)-	capillary		
capit-	head		decapitation
capn-	smoke; carbon dioxide		capnography
caps-	container		capsule
carbo(n)-	coal; charcoal		carbohydrate
carcin-	crab; carcinoma; cancer		carcinoma
cardi-	heart; cardia		lipocardiac, bradycardia, sinistrocardial, tachycardia
cari-	rottenness		cariogenesis
carn-	flesh		
carp-	wrist; fruit		
cartilag(in)-	cartilage		
caud-	tail		caudad
cav-	hollow		concave
cel-	hernia; tumour; swelling; protrusion		variocelectomy
cell-	small room; cell		cellular
cement-	rough stone		cementoblast
cen-	common		cenesthesia
cente-	pierce; withdraw fluid by piercing		enterocentesis
centi-	hundred		centimeter, centipede
centr-	point; centre		centrifugal, centromere
cephal-	head		encephalitis, cephalocentesis
cept-	take; receive	usually has a prefix	receptor
cer-	wax		ceroplasty, cerumen
cerat-	horn; cornea		ceratoid
cerc-	tail		onchocerca
cerebell-	brain	diminutive of cerebr-	cerebellifugal
cerebr-	brain		dextrocerebral
cervic-	neck; cervix (neck of the uterus)		laterocervical
chæt-	bristle; hair of mane		
chancr-	crab; cancer		chancroid
cheil-	lip		cheiloschisis
cheir-	hand		macrocheira
chem-	chemical; drug; medicine		chemistry, chemotherapy
chir-	hand		chiropractic
chlor-	green		chlorophyll
choan-	funnel		choanomastigote
chol-	bile; gall	connecting vowel -E-	melancholy
cholang-	bile duct	sometimes cholangi-	cholangitis
cholecyst-	gallbladder		
choledoch-	common bile duct		choledochoplasty
chondr-	cartilage		chondromalacia
chondri-	granule		mitochondria
chord-	string; cord		perichordal
chore-	dance		choreoathetosis
chori-	membrane		choriocarcinoma
choroid-	choroid		
chrom(at)-	colour; pigment		
chron-	time; timing		synchronous
chrys-	gold		chrysotherapy
chy-	pour		ecchymosis
chyl-	milky plant sap; milky intestinal fluid		chyliform, chylopericardium
chym-	gastric pulp		chyme
cid-	kill; cut; destroy		germicidal
cili-	fine hair; eyelash; ciliary body		
cine-	move	also kine-	acrocinesis
cip-	take	usually has a prefix	
cirrh-	orange-yellow		
cirs-	varix (dilated and twisted vein)		cirsophthalmia
cis-	cut; kill		excision
cla-	break; break up; destroy		
clad-	branch		
clavic-	collar bone; clavicle		
cleid-	key; clavicle		cleidocranial
clin-	bend; incline; lay down		clinocephaly
clitor(id)-	clitoris		clitoris
clon-	spasm (involuntary muscle contraction)		
clud-	close		
clus-	close; shut		malocclusion
clys-	irrigate; rinse; inject fluid		
cnid-	nettle		cnidoblast
cocc-	berry; berry-shaped bacterium		gonococcus
coccyg-	coccyx		coccyx
cochle-	spiral; cochlea		
cœl-	hollow		cœlozoic
cœli-	abdomen	cœl- before i—	cœliotomy; cœlitis
cœn-	common		cœnocyte
coin-	common		coinosite
col(on)-	lower intestine; colon		colic
coli-	colon		
coll-	neck		
colp-	hollow; vagina		colpitis
con-	cone		conotruncal
condyl-	knuckle; protuberance on a bone		
coni-	dust		coniofibrosis
copr-	excrement; fæcal matter		coprophilia
cor-	doll; little image; pupil (eye)		isocoria
cor(d)-	heart		
cord-	string; cord		cordotomy
core-	pupil (eye)		
corn-	horn		
corne-	hornlike; cornea		
coron-	crown of head; coronary artery		
corpor-	body		intracorporeal
cortic-	bark; rind; outer layer		corticosterone
cosm-	world; universe		
cost-	rib		intercostal
counter-	against; counter		countertraction
cox-	hip		
crani-	skull		pericranium; cranium
creat-	meat; flesh		creatine
cresc-	grow; begin to grow		
cret-	grow; begin to grow	usually has a prefix	accretion
crin-	secrete		endocrinology
croc-	yellow		
crur-	shin; leg		talocrural
cry-	cold		cryesthesia
crym-	icy cold		crymodynia
crypt-	hidden; secret; latent		cryptorchidism
cubit-	elbow		
cult-	tend; cultivate		culture
cune-	wedge		cuneiform
cupr-	copper		
cusp-	point	adjectival suffix: pertaining to	
cut-	skin		subcutaneous
cutane-	skin		
cyan-	blue		cyanophil
cycl-	circle; cycle; ciliary body		cyclophoria
cye-	be pregnant		cyesis
cymb-	boat		cymbocephaly
cyn-	dog		cynophobia
cyst-	bladder; cyst		cystalgia
cyt-	cell		cytotaxis
dacry-	tear (as in teardrop); lacrimal sac; lacrimal duct		dacryocyst
dactyl-	digit; finger; toe		hexadactyly
dem-	people; population		
dendr-	tree; dendrite; dendron		dendrite
dent-	tooth		interdental
derm(at)-	skin		mesoderm
desm-	ligament; connective tissue; band		syndesmoplasty
dextr-	right (side)		dextrocerebral
dicty-	nest	does take connecting vowel	dictyotene
didym-	twin; testicle		epididymal
digit-	digit; finger; toe		digitigrade
dips-	thirst		polydipsia, dipsogen
disc-	disk		discoplacenta
dist-	distant; distal		
doch-	duct	usually has a prefix	
dol-	hurt; pain		
dolich-	long; narrow; slender		dolichocephalic
dors-	back (of the body)		dorsoventral
drom-	running; flowing; course		
duc-	lead (verb); bring; conduct		
duct-	lead (verb); bring; conduct		
dur-	hard		induration
dynam-	power; force; energy; motion		dynamometer, thermodynamics
ec-	house; environment	really œk- (from Greek) but almost always ec	ecogenetics
ech-	have; hold; be		synechotomy
echin-	hedgehog; spiny		echinophthalmia
echo-	reverberating sound; echo		
econ-	economy	formed from Greek œk- + -o- + nom-	
ectr-	congenital absence		ectrodactyly
elast-	elastic		elastofibroma
elc-	sore; ulcer		cystelcosis
electr-	amber; electricity		electrotherapy
eme-	vomit		
encephal-	brain	en- + cephal-	encephalopathy
enter-	(small) intestine		dysentery
entom-	insect		entomology
eo-	dawn		
eos-	red (stain)		
epipl-	omentum (fatty membrane lining the abdominal cavity)		gastroepiploic
episi-	pubic region; vulva		episiotomy
equin-	horse		
er(ot)-	sexual desire		erotomania
erg-	work; action		energy
erythr-	red; red blood cell		
ethn-	ethnic group		
eury-	wide; dilate		eurygnathism
extern-	outer		
fac-	make; do		
faci-	face; appearance; surface		facies, faciolingual
fact-	made; done		
fæc-	excrement; fæcal matter		
fasci-	band; fascia; membrane supporting muscles		fascia; fasciotomy
febr-	fever		febricity
fect-	made; done	usually has a prefix	defective
felin-	cat		
femin-	woman; female		
femor-	femur		femorotibial
fer-	bear; carry	adjectival suffix (bearing)	
ferr-	iron		ferroprotein
fibr-	fibre; filament; fibrous tissue		chondrofibroma
fibul-	fibula		fibula
fic-	make; do	usually has a prefix	
fil-	thread		filiform
fiss-	split		fission
fistul-	fistula (abnormal body passage)		
flagell-	whip		flagellation
flav-	golden yellow		riboflavin
flect-	bend; divert		deflection
flex-	bend; divert		reflexometer
flor-	flower; blossom		
flu-	flow		fluid
flux-	flow		defluxion
fœt-	fetus		fœtoscope
foli-	leaf		
for-	bore (pierce)		imperforate
formic-	ant		
fract-	break		refraction
frig(or)-	cold		
frond-	leafy branch; frond		
front-	front; frontal bone; forehead		nasofrontal
fruct-	fruit		
fug-	flee; avoid		centrifugal
funct-	perform; serve		malfunction
fund-	pour		infundibulum
fung-	mushroom; fungus		
fus-	pour		diffusion
fus-	spindle; spindle-shaped		fusocellular
gal(act)-	milk		galactorrhea
gam-	marriage; reproductive union		gamete
gangli-	ganglion		ganglitis
gastr-	stomach		cholangiogastrostomy
ge-	earth		geophagia
gelat-	freeze; congeal		gelatin
gemin-	twin; double		quadrigeminal
gen-	knee		
gen(e)-	become; be produced; originate; kind		endogenous
gener-	kind; sort; type		
geni-	chin		genioplasty
genit-	give birth; bring forth; genital		genitourinary
ger(ont)-	old age		gerontology
germ-	bud; early stage growth		germinal
gest-	bear; carry		congestion
geus-	taste		
gingiv-	gum (of the mouth)		gingivitis
gland-	acorn		uniglandular
glandul-	gland		
glauc-	bluish grey		glaucus
gli-	glia; neuroglia		neuraglia, glioma
glomerul-	little ball		glomerulonephritis
gloss-	tongue; language		trichoglossia
glott-	tongue; language		glottic
gluc-	sweet; sugar		glucophore
glutin-	glue		agglutination
glyc-	sweet; sugar		glycemia
glycy-	sweet	can (unusually) have the connecting vowel -Y	glycyrrhiza
gn-	be born	usually has a prefix	
gnath-	(lower) jaw		orthognathous
gno-	know; discern		diagnosis
gon-	knee		gonarthrosis, gonocampsis
gon(ad)-	seed; offspring; sex glands; sex organs		gonocyte, gonorrhœa, gonadoblastoma
goni-	angle		goniometer, goniotomy
grad-	walk; take steps		retrograde
gram-	record (the verb)		
gran-	grain; particle		lipogranuloma
granul-	granule		
graph-	write; writing; to record; recording		angiography
grav-	heavy		multigravida
gravid-	pregnant		
gryp-	curved; hooked		
gurgit(at)-	flood; flow		
gutt-	drop (of liquid)		
gymn-	naked; uncovered		gymnospore
gyn(æc)-	woman; female		androgyny
gyr-	ring; circle		gyrospasm
hæm(at)-	blood		hæmangioma, hæmaphysalis
hal-	salt		
halit-	breath		
halluc-	big toe		
hamart-	fault		hamartoma
haph-	touch		
hapl-	simple; single		haplotype
hapt-	touch		haptics
hel-	nail; corn; callus		heloma
helc-	sore; ulcer		keratohelcosis
heli-	sun		heliotaxis
helic-	coil; spiral; twist		helicotrema
helminth-	worm		
hen-	one		henogenesis
hepat-	liver		hepatocele; hepatectomy
hered-	heir		heredofamilial
herni-	protrusion		
herpet-	creep; reptile; herpes; creeping skin disease		herpetophobia, herpetiform
hex-	have; hold; be		cachexia
hidr-	sweat		hyperhidrosis
hipp-	horse		hippocampus
hist-	web; tissue		histocompatibility
hod-	road; path		hodoneuromere
hol-	entire; whole; all		holosystoli
hom(in)-	human; man		
horm-	impetus; impulse		hormone
hum-	soil; ground		
humer-	humerus		
hyal-	glass		hyaloplasm
hydat-	water		hydatoid
hydr-	water; fluid		achlorhydria, hydrocele
hygien-	health		hygiene
hygr-	moist		hygrometry
hyl-	matter; material; wood		hylotropy
hymen-	membrane; hymen		hymenopteran, hymenectomy
hypn-	sleep		hypnotic
hyps-	height		hypsarrhythmia
hyster-	uterus		hysteropexy
iatr-	healer; physician; treatment		pediatrics
ichthy-	fish; scaly		ichthyosis
icter-	jaundice		icterohepatitis
idi-	peculiar; separate; distinct		idiosyncrasy
idi-	self; one's own		
ile-	lower abdomen; intestines; ileum		ileostomy
ili-	lower abdomen; intestines; ilium		iliofemoral
immun-	safe; protected; immune		
in-	fibre; muscle		inotropic
incud-	anvil; incus		incus
inferior-	below; lower		
inguin-	groin		
ini-	occiput (external occipital protuberance)		iniencephaly
insul-	island		insulin
iod-	violet; iodine		
ipsi-	self		ipsilateral
ir(id)-	rainbow; iris		
is-	equal; same; similar; alike		isotonic, isotope
isch-	suppress; check; hold back		ischæmia
ischi-	hip; haunch		ischiopubic
jact-	throw		jactitation
ject-	throw	jact- following a prefix	injection
jejun-	empty; jejunum		gastrojejunostomy
jug-	yoke		conjugation
junct-	yoke; join		
kak-	bad; abnormal		kakodyl
kal-	potassium		
kary-	nut; kernel; nucleus	also cary-	eucaryotae
kerat-	horn; cornea		keratolysis
kin-	move; motion; movement		
kine-	move; motion; movement		kinescope
klept-	steal; theft		kleptomania
koni-	dust		
lab-	slide; slip		
labi-	lip		labiomental
lacer-	tearing		
lacrim-	tear; lacrimal sac; lacrimal duct	older spellings, lacrym- or lachrym-	
lact-	milk		lactiferous
lacun-	gap; cavity		
læv-	left (side)		lævocardia
lal-	talk; speech		glossolalia
lapar-	abdomen; abdominal wall		laparotomy
laps-	slide; slip		
laryng-	larynx		laryngectomy
lat-	bear; carry		translation
lat-	wide		
later-	side		anterolateral, laterocervical, posterolateral, ventrolateral
lecith-	yolk		isolecithal
lectul-	bed; couch		
lei-	smooth		leiomyoma
lent-	lentil; lens		lenticonus
lep-	take; seize		catalepsy
lepid-	scale (on an animal)		
lept-	thin; fine; slight; slender; seizing; taking		leptomeninges
leuk-	white; white blood cell		leucocyte, leukæmia
lev-	light (weight)		
lex-	read; word		
lien-	spleen		lienocele
lig-	tie; bind		ligature
lign-	wood		
lingu-	tongue		sublingual
lip-	fat		glycolipid
lith-	stone; calculus	-lite in a geological context	nephrolithotomy
loc-	place (location)		locomotion
log-	word; speak; study of; science of		logorrhœa
loph-	ridge; tuft		lophotrichous
luc-	light		
lumb-	loin		lumbago

lumin-	light; lumen (cavity within a tube, anatomical or other, or cell wall)		lumen
lun-	moon		
lute-	yellow		luteoma
ly(s)-	loose; dissolve; break down; destroy; decompose		lyophilization, lysogen
lymph(at)-	lymph		lymphadenopathy
macr-	large; long		macromyeloblast
malac-	soft		osteomalacia
malle-	hammer		malleus
mamm-	breast		submammary
man-	hand	combining vowel sometimes -u-	manipulation
man-	excessive preoccupation; anger; insanity; morbid fondness		
mandibul-	lower jaw		
mast-	breast		hypermastia
maxill-	upper jaw		
maz-	breast		
meat-	passage; opening; meatus		meatus
mechan-	machine		mechanoreceptor
medi-	middle		mediolateral
medull-	marrow; medulla oblongata		
mega(l)-	great; large; long		megacolon, megavolt
mel-	limb; member		symmelia
mel-	cheek		meloplasty
melan-	black; dark		melancholy; melanocyte
meli(t)-	honey		melibiose
meliss-	bee		
men-	month; menstruation; menstruation cycle		
mening-	membrane; meninges; meningeal membrane		meningitis
ment-	mind; chin		dementia
mer-	thigh		meralgia
mer-	part		polymeric
mes-	middle; secondary; partial; mesentery		mesoderm
mesi-	in the middle		mesiodens
metr-	measure		audiometry
metr-	womb		endometritis
mi-	smaller		miosis
micr-	small		microbe
mis-	aversion; hatred		
miss-	send		intromission
mit-	thread		mitochondria
mne-	remember		amnesia
mnem-	remember		
mogi-	with difficulty		mogiarthria
molybd-	lead (metal)		
morb-	disease		
morph-	form; shape; structure		polymorphonuclear, homeomorphous, polymorphic
mort-	death		
mot-	move		vasomotor
muc-	mucus		mucilage, mucogingival, mucoprotein
muscul-	muscle	diminutive of mus- "mouse"	
mustel-	weasel		
mut-	change; genetic change	combining vowel -A-	
my-	shut; close		
my-	muscle; mouse		leiomyoma
myc(et)-	fungus; mushroom		streptomycin
myel-	bone marrow; spinal cord; myelin		poliomyelitis
myring-	tympanic membrane		myringotomy
mys-	muscle		
myx-	mucus		myxedema
nan-	dwarf; tiny		nanophthalmos, nanometer
narc-	stupor; numbness; sleep		narcolepsy
nas-	nose		nasopalatine
nat-	birth		
natr-	sodium		
ne-	new; young		neonate
necr-	death; corpse		necrophilia
nema(t)-	thread; roundworm		nematocyst
nephel-	cloud; mist		nephelometer
nephr-	kidney		paranephric
neur-	nerve; nervous system; neuron; emotion		neuralgia, neurasthenia
neutr-	neither		neutrophil
nev-	birthmark; mole		nevolipoma
nid-	nest		
nigr-	black		
no-	mind; mental activity; comprehension		
noci-	injure		nociceptor
nocti-	night		
nod-	knot; nodes		nodosity; multinodal
nom-	law; custom		taxonomy
nom(in)-	name		
norm-	rule		normotensive
nos-	disease; illness		nosology
not-	(human / animal) back; south		notochord
nuc-	nut		
nucle-	kernel		nucleocapsid
nutri-	nourish		malnutrition
nyct-	night		nyctophobia
nymph-	bride		nymphomania, nymphotomy
o-	egg		oogenesis
oct-	eight		octigravida
ocul-	eye		oculomotor
od-	form		orthodic
od-	road; path; form		nematode; cathode
odont-	tooth		orthodontia
odyn-	pain; distress		gastrodynia, odynophagia
oede-	swelling		oedematous
oedema(t)-	swelling		
oesophag-	oesophagus		
ole-	oil		oleoresin
olecran-	elbow		
olig-	few; small; deficient		oligocythemia
om-	shoulder		omalgia
oma(t)-	tumour; disease		
oment-	omentum		
omni-	all; every		
omphal-	navel; umbilicus		omphalectomy
onc-	tumour; swelling; abnormal mass		oncogenesis
onch-	barb; hook		onchocerca
oneir-	dream		oneirogenic
ont-	being; existence		
onych-	nail (finger- or toe-); claw	also onyx-	anonychia
onym-	name		
oophor-	ovary	from o- + phor-	oophorectomy
op-	vision		
ophthalm-	eye		exophthalmos
opisth-	located in the back; behind; backward		opisthotonos, opisthognathous, opisthotonous
ops-	vision		
opt-	visible; vision; sight		optics
or-	mouth; opening		intraoral
orb-	circle		suborbital
orchi-	testicle	also orch-, orche-, orchid-	orchiopathy
orex-	have an appetite		
organ-	implement; instrument		organomegaly
ornith-	bird		
orth-	straight; erect; normal; right		orthopedics
os-	mouth; opening		
osche-	scrotum		
oscill-	swing		oscillopsia
osm-	osmosis		
osm-	odour		osmophore
osphr-	(sense of) smell; odour	-osphresia [AN]	also -osphresis
oss-	bone		ossiferous
ost(e)-	bone		enostosis, osteoarthritis
ot-	ear		parotid, ototoxic
ov-	egg; ovum		synovia, ovovegetarian
ovari-	ovary		ovariopexy
oxy-	sharp; acid; oxygen	sometimes oxi-	oxycephalic, oxidation
oxysm-	sudden		
pachy-	thick; heavy		pachyderma
paed-	child		paediatrics
paen-	deficiency; disease		
pag-	fix; make fast		thoracopagus
palat-	palate		palatorrhaphy
pale-	old; ancient		paleocortex
pallid-	pale; lacking colour		
palpebr-	eyelid		
pancreat-	pancreas		pancreatic
par-	bear; give birth to		primapara
pariet-	wall		parietofrontal
part-	bear; give birth to		parturition
path-	disease; that which one undergoes; suffering	"pathology" often just means "illness"	pathology, psychopathic, cardiopathy
pauci-	few		pauciarticular
pec-	fix; make fast		amylopectin
pector-	chest; breast		
ped-	foot; soil		pedicure, pediatrics
pedicul-	louse / lice		
pell-	skin; hide		pellagra
pelv-	basin; pelvis		
pen-	penis		
pend-	hang down		appendix
peps-	digest		eupepsia
pept-	digest		dyspeptic
per-	deformity		
perine-	perineum (region between anus and scrotum or vulva)		
peritone-	peritoneum (serous membrane lining the abdominal cavity)		
pero-	maimed		perosplanchnia
pest-	plague		
pet-	seek; tend toward		centripetal
petr-	stone; rock		
pex-	fix; make fast (surgically attach)		hepatopexy
pha-	say; speak; communicate		dysphasia
phag-	eat; swallow; devour		dysphagia
phak-	lentil; lens	also phac-	phakitis; phacosclerosis
phalang-	line of soldiers; finger bone; toe bone		phalangectomy
phall-	penis		phalloplasty
phan-	show; be seen		phanerosis
pharmac(eut)-	medicine; drug		pharmacognosy
pharyng-	throat; pharynx		pharyngocele
phas-	speech		aphasia
phe-	dun; dusky		pheomelanin
phem-	speech		
phen-	appearance		phosphene, phenocopy
pher-	bear; support		periphery
phil-	like; have an affinity for		eosinophilia
phleb-	vein		periphlebitis
phlegm(at)-	phlegm		
phlog-	burn; inflame		phlogogenic
phob-	fear; dread; intense dislike		claustrophobia
phon-	sound		phonocardiography
phon-	voice; sound		
phor-	bear; carry; comportment; mental state	-phoria [AN]	exophoria
phos-	light		phosphorus
phot-	light		photophobia
phrag-	fence; wall off; stop up	sometimes phrac-	diaphragm
phrax-	fence; wall off; stop up		urethrophraxis
phren-	mind; diaphragm		phrenoplegia, phrenotropic
phthi-	decay; waste away		phthisis
phthir-	louse / lice		
phy-	beget; bring forth; produce; be (by nature)		osteophyte
phyc-	seaweed		phycochrome
phyl-	tribe; kind		phylogeny
phylac-	guard; protect		prophylactic
phyll-	leaf		chlorophyll, phylloerythrin
phys-	gas; air		physometra
physe-	blow; inflate		emphysema
physi-	nature; appearance		physiology
phyt-	plant; growth		phytobezoar, dermatophyte
picr-	bitter		picrogeusia
piez-	press; pressure; mechanical stress		piezoelectricity
pil-	hair		epilation
pisc-	fish		
pituit-	phlegm; rheum		pituitary
placent-	placenta		extraplacental
plant-	sole (of the foot)		
plas-	form; develop; grow		rhinoplasty
plasm(at)-	plasma		plasma
plast-	form; develop; grow		
platy-	broad; flat		platypodia
plec-	paralyze; strike		
pleg-	paralyze; strike		diplegia
pleio-	more		pleiotropy
pleo-	more		pleomorphism
plet-	fill		plethora
pleur-	rib; side; pleura		pleuralgia
plex-	network; plexus		
plex-	strike; paralyze		apoplexy
plica-	fold		complication, plicate
plumb-	lead (metal)		
plur-	many; multiple; more	combining vowel -I-	pluriglandular
pneum(at)-	gas; air; breath		pneumatocele
pneum(on)-	lung		pneumonotomy
pne-	breathe		orthopnea
pod-	foot		podiatry
poen-	need; lack		neutropenia
poie-	produce; make; form		sarcopoietic
poikil-	spotted; mottled; variegated		poikiloderma
pol-	axis (of a sphere); pole		unipolar
poli-	grey; grey matter (of the brain / spinal cord)		poliomyelopathy
pont-	bridge		pontocerebellar
por-	callus		porokeratosis
por-	passage; opening; duct; pore; cavity		poradenitis
porphyr-	purple		
pos-	drink		hyperposia
posit-	put; place		repositor
poster-	behind; in back		posterior; posterolateral
presby-	old; old age		presbyopia
press-	press		pressoreceptive
prim-	first; first time		
proct-	anus; rectum		proctology
prosop-	face		prosopagnosia
prostat-	prostate gland		
prur-	itch		pruritus
psamm-	sand		psammoma
pseud-	false		pseudoparaplegia; pseudopod
psych-	soul; mind		psychosomatic
psychr-	cold		psychroalgia
pt-	prolapse; fall; sag; drop	-ptosis [AN]	nephroptosis
pter-	wing		
pty(al)-	saliva		ptyalism
pub-	pubis; pubic hair; pubic bone; pubic region		
puber-	puberty		
pulm(on)-	lung; pulmonary artery		pulmogram; cardiopulmonary
puls-	drive		propulsion
punct-	prick; pierce		punctiform
pupill-	pupil (eye); girl		pupillometry
pur-	pus	combining vowel -u-	suppuration
purpur-	purple		
py-	pus		spondylopyosis
pyel-	trough; basin; pelvis; renal pelvis		nephropyelitis
pyg-	rump		pygalia
pykn-	thick; frequent	also pycn-	pycnomorphous, pyknophrasia
pyl-	door; orifice		pylephlebitis
pyle-	portal vein		
pylor-	pylorus		
pyr(et)-	fever; fire; burning		pyrogen
pyrex-	be feverish		
rachi-	spine		rachiodynia
rad(ic)-	root		
radi-	ray; medical imaging; radiation; radius		irradiation, radiocarpal
ram-	branch		
raph-	stitch; suture		
rect-	straight; rectum		rectocele
ren-	kidney		adrenal, renography
ret(in)-	net; retina; network; plexus		retiform
rhabd-	rod; rod-shaped; striated		rhabdomyolysis
rhachi-	spine; vertebrae		
rhag-	hemorrhage; flow profusely; profuse flow or discharge; break; burst forth		hemorrhagic
rhaph-	suture		arteriorrhaphy
rheum(at)-	watery flow		
rhex-	break; burst		metrorrhexis
rhex-	rupture; bursting (of tissues)	-rrhexis [AN]	
rhin-	nose		rhinoplasty
rhiz-	root; nerve root		rhizotomy
rhod-	rose; pink; red		rhodopsin
rhe-	flow; secretion; discharge		diarrheal
rhythm-	rhythm; heartbeat		
rhytid-	wrinkle		rhytidectomy
rot-	wheel		rotation
rub(r)-	red		bilirubin
rube-	reddish		
sacchar-	sugar		saccharimeter
sacr-	sacred; sacrum		sacralgia
sept-	fence; wall off; stop up; septum		septonasal
sal-	salt		
salping-	tube; trumpet; Fallopian tube; biological tube		salpingitis
sangu(in)-	blood		sanguifacient
sapr-	rotten; putrid; decaying		saprophyte
sarc-	flesh; soft tissue		sarcoma
saur-	lizard; dinosaur		
scaph-	skiff; light boat; scapha; scaphoid bone		scaphocephaly
scapul-	shoulder blade		
scat-	excrement; faecal matter		scatology
schis-	split		schistocyte, thoracoschisis
schist-	split; cleft; fissure		
schiz-	split; cleft; fissure		schizonychia
scirrh-	hard		scirrhous
scler-	hard; sclera		sclerosis
scoli-	twisted; crooked; bent		scoliokyphosis
scop-	examine; look at		endoscope
scot-	darkness		scotophobia
scrot-	scrotum		scrotum
seb-	sebum; oily secretion		sebum
sect-	cut		section
sem(in)-	seed; semen		
sens-	perceive; feel		sensory
sep-	rot; decay		sepsis
ser-	whey; watery substance; serum		serosynovitis
set-	hair; bristle		
sex(u)-	sexual desire		sexopathy
sial-	saliva; salivary duct		sialadenitis
sider-	iron		sideroblast
sin-	hollow; fold; bend; curve; sinus		sinobronchitis
sinistr-	left (side)		sinistrocerebral, sinistrocardial
sinus-	sinus		
sit-	food		parasitic
skelet-	skeleton		
sol-	sun		
solen-	channel; gutter; pipe		solenonychia
solut-	loosen; dissolve; set free		dissolution
som(at)-	body		chromosome, psychosomatic
somn-	sleep		somnambulism
son-	sound		
spas-	draw; pull		spasm, spastic
spasm-	spasm (involuntary muscle contraction)		spasm
spectr-	appearance		microspectroscope
sperm(at)-	seed; sperm; semen		spermicide, spermatozoon
spers-	scatter		dispersion
sphen-	wedge		sphenoid
spher-	ball		hemisphere
sphincter-	sphincter muscle		
sphygm-	pulse		sphygmograph, sphygmomanometer
spin-	spine		spinocerebellar
spir-	spiral; coil		spirochete
spir(at)-	breathe		spirometry
splanchn-	entrails; viscera		neurosplanchnic
splen-	spleen		splenomegaly
spondyl-	vertebra		spondylolisthesis
spongi-	sponge		spongioblastoma
spor-	seed; spore		sporocyst, zoospore
squam-	scale (e.g. of a reptile or fish)		desquamation
sta-	make stand; stop		haemostasis
stabil-	stable; fixed		
stabl-	stable; fixed		
stann-	tin		
staped-	stirrup; stapes		stapes
staphyl-	bunch of grapes; uvula		staphylococcus, staphyloedema
stat-	stop; stand; make stand; control		
stear-	fat; sebum; sebaceous glands		stearate
steat-	fat		steatorrhea
sten-	narrow; constricted; abnormal narrowing		stenothorax
ster-	solid		cholesterol
sterc(or)-	excrement; faecal matter		stercoroma
stere-	solid; three-dimensional		stereotactic
stern-	chest; breast; breastbone (sternum)		sternalgia, sternoschisis
steth-	chest; breast		stethoscope
sthen-	strength		asthenia
stigm(at)-	point; mark; spot		
stol-	send		diastole
stom(at)-	mouth; opening		stomatalgia; anastomosis
stomach-	stomach		
strat-	layer		
strep-	twisted; twisted chains	form of streph- before t—	streptomycin
streph-	twisted; twisted chains	sometimes strep- before t—	strephosymbolia
strict-	draw tight; compress; cause pain		constriction
stroph-	twist		angiostrophe
struct-	pile up (against)		obstruction
styl-	stake; pole		stylohyoid, stylosteophyte
sud-	sweat; fluid		
sulc-	groove; furrow		
superior-	above		superior
synap-	synapse	sometimes synaps-	
syndesm-	connective tissue; ligament		syndesmophyte
synovi-	synovial (fluid / membrane / sac)		
syring-	syringe; tube; fistula (abnormal body passage); cavity; oviduct; sweat glands		syringocystadenoma
ta-	stretch; put under tension		ectasia
tac-	order; arrange		atactiform
tach-	rapid		tachography
tachy-	rapid	no combining vowel	tachycardia
tact-	touch		contact
taenia-	tape		taeniafuge
tal-	talus; ankle		talus
tars-	broad / flat surface; tarsus		tarsorrhaphy
taur-	bull		taurodontism
taut-	same		tautomerism
tax-	coordination; order; arrangement		ataxia
tect-	cover		protective
teg-	cover		integument
tel-	end; purpose; completion		telomere
tempor-	time; temporal bone; temple (of the head)		temporomandibular
ten(ont)-	tightly stretched band; tendon		tenodynia; tenontology
tend(in)-	tendon		tendovaginal, tendinitis
tens-	stretch; strain; force		extensor
terat-	monster		teratoma
terr-	earth; land		
test-	testicle		testis
thanat-	death		thanatophobia
the-	put; place		synthesis
thec-	repository		thecostegnosis
thel-	teat; nipple	combining vowel -e-	thelerethism
therap(eut)-	treat medically; heal		chemotherapy
theri-	animal		
therm-	heat; temperature		diathermy
thi-	sulfur		thiazole, thiocyanate
thigm-	touch		thigmotaxis
thorac-	chest; chest cavity; pleural cavity; thorax		thoracoplasty
thromb-	lump; clot; blood clot		thrombocytopenia
thym-	thymus		thymoma
thym-	soul; spirit		dysthymia, thymoleptic
thyr-	shield; thyroid gland		
tibi-	tibia		tibia
tme-	cut		axonotmesis
toc-	childbirth; labour		dystocia
tom-	cutting; slice; incision		tomography
ton-	stretch; put under tension; tone		isotonic
top-	place (location)		topesthesia, isotope
tors-	twist		torsion
tox-	poison		toxaemia
trache-	windpipe; trachea		tracheotomy
trachel-	neck; cervix		trachelopexy
tract-	draw; drag		protraction
traumat-	wound		traumatic
trep-	turn; twist		treponema
trich-	hair		trichobezoar
trip-	rub		lithotripsy
trop-	turn; react; preferentially affect		sitotropism
troph-	feed; nourish; grow		atrophy
tub-	pipe; tube		tuboplasty
tuber-	swelling; node		tubercle
tum-	be swollen	combining vowel -E-	
tuss-	cough		
tympan-	drum; eardrum; middle ear		tympanum; tympanocentesis
typ-	type		atypical
typh-	fog; fever; typhus; typhoid		
typhl-	blind; caecum		typhlectomy
tyr-	cheese		tyrogenous
ul-	scar		ulerythema
ul-	gum (of the mouth)		ulatrophy
uln-	ulna		ulna
umbilic-	navel; umbilicus		umbilicus
un-	one	combining vowel -i-	uniaxial
ungu-	nail; claw		
ur-	tail		uropod; anura
ur(in)-	urine; urinary tract; uric acid; in the urine		polyuria
uran-	vault of heaven; roof of the mouth		uranostaphyloplasty
ureter-	ureter		ureterography
urethr-	urethra		urethropexy
uter-	womb; belly; uterus		uterorectal
vacc-	cow		vaccine
vag-	vagus (a specific nerve)		
vagin-	sheath; vagina		invagination, vaginitis
varic-	varix (dilated and twisted vein)		varicocele
vas-	(blood) vessel; vas deferens		
ven-	vein		venopressor
ven(en)-	poison	also venom-	
ventr-	abdomen; belly; abdominal cavity; front		ventrocystorrhaphy
verb-	word		
verm(in)-	worm		
vers-	turn		inversion
vert-	turn		diverticulum
vertebr-	vertebra		vertebra
vesic-	bladder		vesicovaginal
vide-	see		videolaparoscopy
viol-	violet		
vir-	virus		virus
virid-	green		
viscer-	internal organ; viscus	["viscus" is the singular of "viscera"]	visceromotor
viscus-	internal organ; viscus	["viscus" is the singular of "viscera"]	
vit-	life		devitalize
vitre-	glassy		
vivi-	alive; living		viviparous
vuls-	pull; twitch		convulsion
vulv-	vulva		
xanth-	yellow; blond		xanthochromia
xen-	strange; foreign; alien		xenograph
xer-	dry		xeroderma
xiph-	sword; xiphoid process		xiphodynia
xyl-	wood		
zo-	animal; organism		microzoon
zyg-	yoke; union		zygodactyly
zym-	fermentation; enzyme		enzyme